

An Act

ENROLLED HOUSE
BILL NO. 2961

By: Hildebrant, Deck, Menz,
Fugate, Wolfley, and
Rosecrants of the House

and

Woods of the Senate

An Act relating to postsecondary education; creating the TSgt Marshal Dakota Roberts Gold Star Survivor Act; waiving tuition for the spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 3218.7-1, as amended by Section 2, Chapter 382, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 3218.7-1), which relates to waiver of room and board fees; expanding application of waiver to the spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-134, which relates to waiver of tuition at career technology districts; waiving tuition and fees for the spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient; amending Section 3, Chapter 382, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 14-134.1), which relates to waiver of fees at career technology districts; waiving fees for the spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient; providing for noncodification; providing for codification; and providing an effective date

SUBJECT: Postsecondary education

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law not to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes reads as follows:

This act shall be known and may be cited as the "TSgt Marshal Dakota Roberts Gold Star Survivor Act".

SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3218.7-2 of Title 70, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

Within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education, no resident tuition or nonresident tuition shall be charged to the spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient who was killed in the line of duty in any branch of the United States Armed Forces, provided that either:

1. The Gold Star recipient was a legal resident of the State of Oklahoma at the time of death; or
2. The spouse or child maintains residency in the State of Oklahoma during enrollment.

SECTION 3. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 3218.7-1, as amended by Section 2, Chapter 382, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 3218.7-1), is amended to read as follows:

Section 3218.7-1. A. Within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education, no fees nor room and board shall be charged to:

1. Children of Oklahoma peace officers as defined by Section 648 of Title 21 of the Oklahoma Statutes who have given their lives in the line of duty;
2. Children of Oklahoma firefighters who have given their lives in the line of duty;
3. Children of commissioned members of the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System, who have given their lives in the line of duty; ~~and~~
4. Children of Oklahoma emergency medical technicians who have given their lives in the line of duty; and
5. The spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient who was killed in the line of duty in any branch of the United States Armed Forces, provided that either:

- a. the Gold Star recipient was a legal resident of the State of Oklahoma at the time of death, or

b. the spouse or child maintains residency in the State of Oklahoma during enrollment.

B. Such waiver of fees and room and board shall be limited to a period of five (5) years.

C. Such waiver of fees and room and board shall be a service benefit of a commissioned member of the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System.

D. For purposes of this section:

1. "Firefighter" means a volunteer firefighter or a permanent salaried professional member of any fire department within the State of Oklahoma; and

2. "Emergency medical technician" means a person volunteering or employed as an emergency medical technician and who is licensed as an emergency medical technician pursuant to Section 1-2505 of Title 63 of the Oklahoma Statutes.

SECTION 4. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-134, is amended to read as follows:

Section 14-134. A. Within the system of career technology districts, no resident tuition or nonresident tuition shall be charged to ~~the~~:

1. Children of Oklahoma peace officers as defined by Section 648 of Title 21 of the Oklahoma Statutes who have given their lives in the line of duty;

2. Children of Oklahoma firefighters who have given their lives in the line of duty;

3. Children of members of the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System who have given their lives in the line of duty or whose disability is by means of personal and traumatic injury of a catastrophic nature, as defined by Section 2-300 of Title 47 of the Oklahoma Statutes, and occurred in the line of duty; ~~and~~

4. Children of Oklahoma emergency medical technicians who have given their lives in the line of duty; and

5. The spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient who was killed in the line of duty in any branch of the United States Armed Forces, provided that either:

- a. the Gold Star recipient was a legal resident of the State of Oklahoma at the time of death, or
- b. the spouse or child maintains residency in the State of Oklahoma during enrollment.

B. Such waiver of resident tuition and nonresident tuition shall be limited to a period of five (5) years.

C. Such waiver of resident tuition or nonresident tuition to the children of deceased peace officers and to the children of deceased firefighters as provided for in this section shall be a service benefit of each Oklahoma peace officer and Oklahoma firefighter.

D. For purposes of this section:

1. "Firefighter" means a volunteer firefighter or a permanent salaried professional member of any fire department within the State of Oklahoma; and

2. "Emergency medical technician" means a person volunteering or employed as an emergency medical technician and who is licensed as an emergency medical technician pursuant to Section 1-2505 of Title 63 of the Oklahoma Statutes.

SECTION 5. AMENDATORY Section 3, Chapter 382, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 14-134.1), is amended to read as follows:

Section 14-134.1. A. Within the system of career technology districts, no fees shall be charged to:

1. Children of Oklahoma peace officers as defined by Section 648 of Title 21 of the Oklahoma Statutes who have given their lives in the line of duty;

2. Children of Oklahoma firefighters who have given their lives in the line of duty;

3. Children of commissioned members of the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System, who have given their lives in the line of duty; ~~and~~

4. Children of Oklahoma emergency medical technicians who have given their lives in the line of duty; and

5. The spouse or children of a Gold Star recipient who was killed in the line of duty in any branch of the United States Armed Forces, provided that either:

a. the Gold Star recipient was a legal resident of the State of Oklahoma at the time of death, or

b. the spouse or child maintains residency in the State of Oklahoma during enrollment.

B. Such waiver of fees shall be limited to a period of five (5) years.

C. Such waiver of fees shall be a service benefit of a commissioned member of the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System.

D. For purposes of this section:

1. "Firefighter" means a volunteer firefighter or a permanent salaried professional member of any fire department within the State of Oklahoma; and

2. "Emergency medical technician" means a person volunteering or employed as an emergency medical technician and who is licensed as an emergency medical technician pursuant to Section 1-2505 of Title 63 of the Oklahoma Statutes.

SECTION 6. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

Passed the House of Representatives the 5th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the 27th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____